

## Workforce Programs: Working Together to Power Nevada's Health Workforce

April 2026

**Three separate programs.**  
**Three opportunities.**  
**Three key pathways.**

These workforce programs, while separate from each other, will work in conjunction to build a sustainable, homegrown healthcare infrastructure by aligning medical training with targeted financial incentives to ensure every Nevada community has access to a high-quality, permanent health provider network.



### **Graduate Medical Education (GME) Program:**

The foundation. By training residents locally, the state increases the statistical likelihood that they will remain in Nevada to practice.



### **Workforce Recruitment and Rural Access Program (WRRAP):**

The bridge. WRRAP ensures that rural health facilities have the technical and operational capacity to absorb the talent from GME and other workforce programs.



### **Statewide Healthcare Access and Recruitment Program (SHARP):**

The anchor. SHARP works to alleviate statewide healthcare professional and expertise shortages – in specifically the areas the state needs most.

## **COLLECTIVE IMPACT: Strong & Sustainable Statewide Healthcare Workforce**

## Graduate Medical Education (GME) Program:

Visit the [GME Program Website](#) for additional information, or reach out to [GME@nvha.nv.gov](mailto:GME@nvha.nv.gov)

| Focus                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Administration                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Funding                                                                                                                                                                                             |
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| <p><b>Geography:</b> Statewide</p> <p><b>Goals:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Create, expand or retain programs for residency training and postdoctoral fellowships, approved by the Accreditation Council for GME (ACGME).</li><li>• To address geographic areas and populations where the shortage of healthcare providers and specialties is most critical as identified in the April 2025 <a href="#">Physician Workforce in Nevada</a> analysis conducted by the Nevada Health Workforce Research Center at UNR.</li></ul> <p><b>Summary:</b><br/>The GME program is responsible for the vital task of expanding medical residency and fellowship programs throughout the state. By investing directly into existing and new institutional programs, its primary impact is that it provides the necessary structure allowing future physicians to complete their critical years of specialty training within the state, significantly increasing the likelihood that they will choose to practice in Nevada permanently. The rotation of the GME program ensures a steady supply of qualified, locally trained physicians, which feeds the entire state health ecosystem. It helps create the future workforce capacity that the WRRAP and SHARP programs will ultimately work to place in underserved and rural areas.</p> | <p><b>Governance:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <a href="#">NRS 223.631-639</a></li><li>• <a href="#">SB262</a> &amp; <a href="#">SB494</a> (2025)</li></ul> <p>Began in 2014 as ‘GME Task Force’ through Governor Executive Order 2014-07. Purpose was to provide recommendations to the Governor about how to increase graduate medical workforce in Nevada.</p> <p>A bill to statutorily establish a GME Advisory Council and grant program was first introduced in the 2023 Session of the Nevada Legislature: Senate Bill 350.</p> | <p><b>Source:</b> State General Fund</p> <p>\$15.8M available in SFY26 for GME Grant Program Round VIII; see open Request for Application (RFA) <a href="#">here</a>. RFA open through 4/24/26.</p> |

# Rural Health Transformation Workforce Recruitment & Rural Access Program (WRRAP)

Visit the [RHT & WRRAP Program Website](#) or contact [RHTP@nvha.nv.gov](mailto:RHTP@nvha.nv.gov) for more information

| Focus                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Administration                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Funding                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
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| <p><b>Geography:</b> Rural Nevada.</p> <p>In accordance with the CMS RHT NOFO, "rural" is strictly defined using the Health Resources and Services Administration (<a href="#">HRSA</a>) <a href="#">Federal Office of Rural Health Policy (FORHP) criteria</a>. <b>Eligible projects must be physically located in, or provide direct service to, populations situated in:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Non-metropolitan counties;</li> <li>• Outlying metropolitan counties with no urban core of 50,000 or more; or</li> <li>• Census tracts within metropolitan counties designated as rural by Rural-Urban Commuting Area (RUCA) codes.</li> </ul> <p><b>Goals:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Aimed to attract and retain physicians and a wide variety of other health care provider types in rural areas of the state with specific retention strategies to ensure WRRAP recipients serve rural Nevada.</li> <li>• Strong preference for awards related to financial incentives and training assistance programs will be given to rural hospitals and health care providers that operate in rural counties including but not limited to rural hospitals, certified community behavioral health centers, federally-qualified health centers, primary and behavioral health providers, school health services programs, school-based health centers, and other health clinics.</li> <li>• Proposals may be entertained from other entities including academic institutions for funding to support the creation of a Rural Physician Residency Program and for additional training assistance programs that will serve rural communities in Nevada.</li> </ul> <p><b>Summary:</b></p> <p>WRRAP targets the unique challenges of healthcare stabilization in Nevada's rural communities. Its core objective is immediate workforce recruitment and crucial retention assistance within areas where geography creates significant access barriers. While focused geographically, the WRRAP relies on the workforce generated by the GME program to recruit qualified individuals and meshes with the SHARP to share strategic recruitment data, ensuring its rural focus complements broader statewide shortages rather than competing for the same resources.</p> | <p><b>Governance:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <a href="#">CMS RHT Notice of Funding Opportunity</a> (NOFO)</li> <li>• <a href="#">Nevada RHT Notice of Award</a> (NOA)</li> <li>• <a href="#">Nevada RHT Plan</a> (Project Narrative)</li> </ul> <p>More information on Nevada's WRRAP and other RHT initiatives: <a href="#">RHTP Initiatives</a>.</p> <p>All projects funded through WRRAP must include a 5-year rural service commitment as described in the <a href="#">CMS Service Commitment Fact Sheet</a>.</p> | <p><b>Source:</b> Centers for Medicare &amp; Medicaid Services (CMS) Rural Health Transformation (RHT) Grant #RHTCMS332074-01-02</p> <p>\$179,931,608.42 awarded to Nevada in Budget Period 1 (12/29/25 – 10/30/26)</p> <p>WRRAP open RFAs located <a href="#">here</a>. Year 1, Round 1 RFAs open through 5/15/26.</p> |

## Statewide Healthcare Access and Recruitment Program (SHARP):

Visit the [SHARP Program Website](#) or contact [SHARP@nvha.nv.gov](mailto:SHARP@nvha.nv.gov) for more information

| Focus                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Administration                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Funding                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
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| <p><b>Geography:</b> Statewide. Key impact is addressing Health Professional Shortage Areas (HPSAs) across the <i>entire</i> state, including high-need urban centers that are not covered by WRRAP.</p> <p><b>Goals:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Support workforce capacity and sustainable health care in Nevada.</li><li>• To award grants of money to fund certain projects to address shortages of health care providers, clinical services, or expertise; or difficulties in accessing health care as identified by the biennial health care needs assessment.</li></ul> <p><b>Needs Assessment Must Include:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• A quantitative analysis of the health care workforce in Nevada;</li><li>• A determination of the most critical shortages in the health care workforce in Nevada; and</li><li>• An identification of unmet needs for specific health technology and therapies.</li></ul> <p><b>Summary:</b></p> <p>SHARP's data and streamlined licensing procedures support the WRRAP initiative's specific needs for rural practitioners and integrate the long-term workforce generated by the GME pipeline, acting as the statewide modernizing administrative force of the state's unified health care workforce strategy.</p> | <p><b>Governance:</b></p> <p><a href="#">Senate Bill 5</a> (2025 Special Session)</p> <p>Major elements of the SHARP through SB5:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• New state general fund account</li><li>• Required biennial assessment &amp; report</li><li>• Grant program managed by NVHA</li><li>• Nevada Interim Finance Committee (IFC) to approve all SHARP grants</li><li>• One-time appropriation of \$60 million</li><li>• 3.5% to NVHA for administrative costs</li></ul> | <p><b>Source:</b> SB5 one-time bill appropriation.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Funds available July 1, 2026.</li><li>• Up to 3.5% of total funds for NVHA administrative costs (SB5, Sec. 8)</li></ul> <p>RFA to be released July 2026.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Specific applicant and project eligibility requirements (SB5, Sec. 10)</li></ul> |